

Why Gen Z is buying fewer TVs

BenQ India MD Rajeev Singh explains

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BenQ India is celebrating a major milestone this year as the company completes 25 years in the country. Over the past two and a half decades, the brand has expanded well beyond monitors to build a strong presence across projectors, interactive flat panels and professional display solutions. During a recent interaction, Digit had the opportunity to sit down with Rajeev Singh, Managing Director of BenQ India, to discuss the company's journey, the philosophy that has guided its growth, changing consumer behaviour, the rise of the Mac ecosystem, Gen Z's evolving entertainment preferences, AI-powered displays, and BenQ's roadmap for the future. Here are the key excerpts from the conversation.

Q BenQ is completing 25 years in India this year. What are the key principles and philosophies that have helped BenQ adapt, survive and lead over these years?

A Rajeev Singh: We have always been very clear about our company's working philosophy. We should be completely focused on our customers and try to give them things they may like to have. They may not even know there's a latent need, but it is there. We should identify those needs and, using our technological progress, build products around them before any of our competitors. That gives us an edge over the competition.

Our focus has always been on customers and our ability to understand

what they may like to have, then convert that into an actual product. This has been one of our fundamental principles and has really helped us over the years. The market has always been up and down, but we've been somewhat insulated because we've consistently launched new products by anticipating trends and planning ahead.

Q Was there any consumer trend or behaviour that you could never have predicted 25 years ago, but is now a reality?

A Rajeev Singh: The biggest change was what happened because of COVID. We always knew people would become more digital, but the speed at which everything changed because of COVID surprised us. The adoption of technology and doing everything digitally and virtually accelerated much faster than we had anticipated.

At the same time, it helped us because digital transformation was already one of our focus areas. Another example is the Mac ecosystem. Today, Apple is close to a 10 per cent laptop market share even in India, and Mac devices have a much longer life cycle than most laptops. That means there are a lot of Macs in use today. Yet there wasn't a brand focused specifically on developing

monitors for Mac users. There were many pain points, especially with colour accuracy.

Q Have younger consumers, especially Gen Z, stopped buying TVs, unlike previous generations?

A Rajeev Singh: Absolutely, especially Gen Z. This phenomenon is extremely prominent.

They want everything to be portable because their

lifestyle is mobile.

They don't want anything bulky.

Many of them live in shared accommodation initially and later move into rented homes. They don't want products that are difficult to move because that slows them down.

Televisions don't fit into that philosophy. However, they still want to watch content on a large screen. That's where smart projectors have become popular. They're compact, come with Google TV built in, don't require additional devices, support OTT apps and are essentially plug-and-play. Unlike traditional projectors, they don't need a dedicated projection screen. They can project onto walls, ceilings or other surfaces, and even compensate for wall colours for picture quality.

Q Where is the highest demand in the projector market?

A Rajeev Singh: Most of the volume today is at the lower end of the market, between Rs 10,000 and Rs 20,000. However, this isn't really the Gen Z segment. ■



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